In most organizations, data is scattered across many data stores, applications, and databases. For example, organizations are often integrated with Confluence, intranet spaces, Slack, email, databases, cloud drives (iCloud drive, Google Drive, etc.), and others. Collating and searching through vast amounts of data with integrations to varied sources is a challenge for these organizations. This is where Elasticsearch can be employed for *Enterprise Search* and data organization.

If we have an online business website amassing data, providing search is something of a bare necessity for attracting customers and keeping them happy. *Site Search* is a software-as-a-service (SaaS) offering from Elastic that, once enabled, crawls through the given site pages, fetching data and building indices backed by Elasticsearch. Once the crawling and indexing are complete, the site can be integrated easily with the search facility. The Site Search module also helps create a search bar and the code snippet related to it. The website administrator can copy the snippet of generated code onto their homepage to enable a search bar instantly, thus making the website fully functional with integrated search.

Business analytics

Organizations capture tons of data from various sources, and that data often holds the key to survival and success. Elasticsearch can help extract trends, statistics, and metrics from data, giving organizations knowledge about their operations, sales, turnover, profits, and many other features for timely management.

Security analytics and threat and fraud detection

Data security and potential breaches of it are nightmares for organizations. Elasticsearch's security analytics help organizations analyze every bit of information—be it from applications, a network, endpoints, or the cloud. This analysis can provide insights into threats and vulnerabilities and let the organization hunt for malware and ransomware, thus alleviating the risk of falling prey to hackers.

Logging and application monitoring

Applications spit out a lot of data in the form of application logs and metrics. These logs provide insights into the health of the application. With the advent of the cloud and the microservices world, logs are scattered across services, and meaningful analysis is a cumbersome affair. Elasticsearch is our friend here. One of the popular use cases for Elasticsearch is indexing logs and analyzing them for application errors and debugging purposes.

Elasticsearch is a powerful and flexible search and analytics engine, but it's not suitable for every use case. Let's briefly go over the issues we may encounter and use cases for which Elasticsearch is the wrong choice.

1.4.4 Unsuitable Elasticsearch uses

Not every use case can be satisfied by Elasticsearch. It is a powerful and flexible search and analytics engine, but unfortunately, this tool has limitations that we must consider before choosing it for our requirements. Here are a few scenarios where Elasticsearch may be an incorrect or inefficient solution: